



AstraZeneca clots

The UK is now offering alternatives to the AstraZeneca vaccine over blood clot concerns.
<http://digit.in/may21-60>



Sawdust 3D printer

Forust, a new 3D printer uses sawdust to print wooden objects.
<http://digit.in/may21-61>

Realme 8 5G

A solid showing for the new Dimensity 700 SoC

While the Realme 8 5G may seem like a simple 5G upgrade over the regular Realme 8, in reality, it isn't really the case. The phone comes with vastly different specs and here's how they pan out.

BUILD AND DISPLAY

The Realme 8 5G weighs 185 g and isn't very thick either at 8.5mm. The back panel features a glossy finish, which, in our opinion, is a step down since matte finishes keep fingerprints at bay and allow users to have a better grip on the phone.

We were slightly disappointed to not see dual stereo speakers since phones at a much lower price point, such as the Poco M3, have also begun offering them.

On to the display, the phone houses a large 6.5-inch Full HD+ IPS LCD display with a 90 Hz refresh rate and a punch-hole selfie camera. In contrast, the Realme 8 priced under ₹15K features a Super AMOLED display and an in-display fingerprint sensor. So, some compromises have been made here to keep the 5G-enabled Realme 8 priced competitively. Lastly, the phone also comes packing WideVine L1 support that allows users to enjoy HD content on streaming platforms.

PERFORMANCE

The Realme 8 5G scored over 100,000 more than the Redmi Note 10 in AnTuTu and over 3000 more in PCMark Work 2.0. It even beat the more expensive Redmi Note 10 Pro and the Realme Narzo 30 Pro, featuring the Dimensity 800U SoC. These benchmark scores should be taken with a grain of salt since MediaTek SoCs are notorious for boosting performance in benchmarks.

Benchmarks aside, the phone feels smooth when playing titles



Price
₹14,999

such as Call of Duty Mobile and Asphalt 9 with little stutter or lag, however, the phone does get considerably warm.

While Realme UI looks pretty clean, it is chock full of third-party preinstalled apps such as Amazon Music, Booking.com, Duo, Netflix, Soloop, and others. Still, it doesn't plague you with as many ads as MIUI does though.

CAMERA

The Realme 8 5G isn't the best performer when it comes to the cameras of the phone. While daylight shots with ample light usually turn out decent with good detail and colour, the dynamic range of the phone is not the best. Realme's NightScape mode doesn't work as expected as well, with Night Mode shots looking almost as grainy, dark and noisy as ones without Night Mode on.

The main camera disappoints yet again as it struggles to blur the background in some shots when portrait mode is active. Additionally, human skin tones are made to look more orange and the face is often softened. The macro lens is yet another disap-

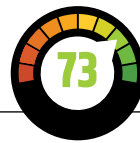
pointment since it lacks autofocus and the shots are often blurry and lack detail.

The 16-megapixel selfie camera shoots decent selfies with a good amount of detail, but the facial features are softened yet again and the orange-ish tint continues to persist. Overall, the Realme 8 5G simply isn't a good option for people who expect consistency and quality from their smartphone cameras.

BATTERY LIFE

If you use the Auto Refresh Rate mode or simply default to 60 Hz, you're looking at a phone that can easily last a day and a half with moderate usage or a full day with heavy usage thanks to a beefy 5000 mAh battery.

The phone supports 18 W fast charging, which is slightly underwhelming since the Realme 8 came with 30 W Dart Charge support. It took 2 hours and 23 minutes to charge the battery from 0 to 100 per cent, which is laboriously slow by 2021 standards.



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VERDICT

The Realme 8 5G is a feather in the company's cap when it comes to performance in phones under ₹20K. What did disappoint us though is the camera proved to be mediocre, at best. If performance matters to you the most, and you're looking for an inexpensive 5G ready phone, the Realme 8 5G is a no-brainer.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR NAME: MediaTek Dimensity 700 | MANUFACTURING PROCESS: 7 nm | ROM: 128 GB, expandable up to 1 TB | RAM: 4/8 GB | DISPLAY TYPE: IPS LCD | DISPLAY SIZE: 6.5-inches | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: Full HD+ (2400x1080) | REFRESH RATE: 90 Hz | REAR CAMERAS: 48 MP + 2 MP + 2 MP | SELFIE CAMERA: 16 MP | BATTERY: 5,000 mAh | CHARGER: 18 W | OS: Realme UI (Android 11) | 5G BANDS SUPPORTED: [NSA] n77/n78/41, [SA] n1/n28A/n41/n78 | WEIGHT: 185 g

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